

Week 3: System Administration and Cybersecurity

Risk Assessment Matrix

Deliverable 3 of 5

Programme	Tech Career Accelerator
Week	Week 3: System Administration and Cybersecurity
Date Range	1st - 5th June
Prepared by	Jodie S and Sisanda M
Document Version	1.0

Objective: Develop comprehensive security, backup, and risk management documentation.

1. Purpose

The purpose of this risk assessment matrix is to identify common technology and cybersecurity risks, estimate their likelihood and impact, and define practical mitigation measures.

2. Risk Assessment Matrix

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Phishing	High	High	Security awareness training, email filtering, MFA, and simulated phishing exercises.
Ransomware	Medium	High	Regular tested backups, endpoint detection and response, patching, and least-privilege access.
Hardware failure	Medium	Medium	Redundant hardware, warranty support, monitoring, and regular maintenance.
Power outage	Medium	High	UPS devices, surge protection, backup power options, and safe shutdown procedures.
Weak or reused passwords	High	Medium	Password complexity rules, password manager use, MFA, and user training.
Unpatched software	Medium	High	Monthly patch cycle, critical patch process, and asset inventory management.
Data loss or accidental deletion	Medium	High	Daily backups, access controls, version history, and user training.
Lost or stolen device	Medium	High	Device encryption, remote wipe, screen locks, and immediate incident reporting.
Unauthorised access	Medium	High	Role-based access control, regular access reviews, MFA, and account monitoring.
Insider misuse	Low	High	Least-privilege access,

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
			logging, user agreements, and management oversight.

3. Risk Rating Guide

Rating	Meaning
Low	Unlikely to occur or limited business impact if it occurs.
Medium	Possible to occur and may disrupt users, data, or services.
High	Likely or severe enough to cause major operational, financial, reputational, or legal impact.

4. Review Process

- The matrix should be reviewed at least annually.
- Risk ratings should be updated after incidents, infrastructure changes, or new systems are introduced.
- High-impact risks should be prioritised for mitigation first.

Approval and Review

This document should be reviewed at least annually and after any major security incident, infrastructure change, or business process change. Updates should be approved by the responsible IT or management representative.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Jodie S	Team member / Prepared by		
Sisanda M	Team member / Prepared by		
	Reviewed by		
	Approved by		